

situation that undermined the military efficiency of the Army of Tennessee. Despite the near mutinous stance of his subordinates, Bragg remained in command through most of 1863.

Brief reprieve

Bragg's victory at Chickamauga was won at heavy cost, but momentarily gave him sufficient prestige to have Polk and some other unruly subordinates removed. But criticism that he had moved too slowly in pursuit of the defeated Union forces after the battle cancelled out any long-term gain to his reputation. His own self-belief, never secure, had long been waning. When Union counterattacks drove his army from the heights outside Chattanooga in November, the mental and physical strain became unbearable and Bragg begged to be relieved of his command. There is no doubting his competence as a planner and administrator, or his ability in training troops, but he lacked the inner strength and decisiveness required of a fighting general.



Zachary Taylor and Braxton Bragg

General Zachary Taylor (in the center) set up camp at Walnut Springs during the War with Mexico in 1846. Bragg, the third man standing to Taylor's left, served with him at Fort Brown, Monterrey, and Buena Vista.